

Research Methodology in Public Administration

Proposal Writing and Report Writing

Bijay Lal Pradhan, PhD

Tribhuvan University
Central Department of Public Administration

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Presentation Outline

What We studied in Sem I

What we will cover in Sem II

From Research Idea to Research Proposal

What We studied in Sem I

Building on Your Previous Knowledge (Sem I)

Philosophy of Social Science & Qualitative Methods

- ▶ Philosophy of social science
- ▶ Rationalism, Empiricism & Sci. Method
- ▶ Theory of Causality
- ▶ Karl Popper's Principle
- ▶ Kuhn's Paradigm Shift
- ▶ Social Science and Natural Science
- ▶ Explanation of Human Action
- ▶ Phenomenology & Social Science
- ▶ Critical Theory
- ▶ Interpretation of Human Action

Data Analysis & Statistical Tools

- ▶ Descriptive statistics
- ▶ Probability & Probability Theory
- ▶ Estimation & Test of Hypothesis
- ▶ Analysis of Variance
- ▶ Simple Regression analysis
- ▶ Multiple Regression analysis
- ▶ Multivariate Analysis
- ▶ Analysis of Contingency Tables
- ▶ Non Parametric Methods
- ▶ Statistical software/tools

From Knowledge to Research

Semester we have achieved the foundation of Research.

Semester II: Where Are We Going?

Proposal Writing → Research Process → Report Writing

What You Already Know

Research Philosophy + Qualitative Methods + Data Analysis



What You Will Learn This Semester

How to transform an **idea or research problem** into a

Research Proposal and Research Report

What we will cover in Sem II

Course Information

Course Details

Course No.:	503
Credit Hours:	3
Title:	Research Methodology in Public Administration III
Focus:	Proposal Writing and Report Writing
Course Type:	Core & Compulsory

Course Objective

The objective of this course is to develop knowledge and skills on:

- ▶ Designing and writing an academic research proposal.
- ▶ Selecting appropriate research methods and designs.
- ▶ Collecting and analyzing research data.
- ▶ Conducting academic research systematically.
- ▶ Writing and presenting a scientific research report.

Course Contents: Foundations of Social Research

1. Overview of Scientific Method and Social Inquiry
2. Varieties of Social Research and Research Process
3. Dimensions and Major Types of Social Research
4. Methodology and Research Philosophies
 - Philosophy and Research Approaches
 - Feminist Research
 - Postmodern Research
5. The Literature Review

Course Contents: Research Design

6. Research Design

- ▶ Quantitative Research Design
- ▶ Qualitative Research Design
- ▶ Mixed Methods Research Design
- ▶ Causal Hypothesis and Testing
- ▶ Potential Errors in Causal Hypothesis:
 - Tautology
 - Teleology
 - Ecological Fallacy
 - Reductionism
 - Spuriousness
- ▶ Qualitative Research Design

Course Contents: Measurement and Sampling

7. Quantitative and Qualitative Measurement

- Conceptualization and Operationalization
- Validity and Reliability
- Levels of Measurement
- Scores, Indexes and Scales

8. Quantitative and Qualitative Sampling

- Probability Sampling
- Non-probability Sampling

Course Contents: Data Collection

9. Data Collection Instruments

- Questionnaire
- Interview
- Observation and its Types
- Participatory Rapid Appraisal
- Ethnography
- Focus Group Discussion
- Case Studies
- Survey Research

10. Survey Research

- Non-reactive Research
- Field Research

Course Contents: Data Analysis

11. Analysis of Data

Quantitative Data

- ▶ Univariate Analysis
- ▶ Bivariate Analysis
- ▶ Multivariate Analysis

Qualitative Data

- ▶ Coding
- ▶ Categorization
- ▶ Thematic Analysis
- ▶ Interpretation

Major Components of the Course

1. Ethics in Social Research
2. Writing of Research Proposal
3. Conducting Academic Research
4. Analysis and Interpretation of Data
5. Scientific Report Writing

Research Idea → Proposal → Research → Report

Research Productivity Tools and Digital Skills

1. Academic Literature Search

[Google Scholar](#), [Semantic Scholar](#), academic databases, Boolean search, and citation searching.

2. Reference Management

[Zotero](#)/ [Mendeley](#), citation management, bibliography generation, and reference organization.

3. Digital Literature Review

Literature matrix, [ResearchRabbit](#), [Connected Papers](#), and research gap identification.

4. Digital Research Writing

[Microsoft Word](#), [Overleaf](#)/LaTeX, collaborative writing, formatting, and document management.

Research Productivity Tools and Digital Skills (Continued)

5. Digital Data Collection

[Google Forms](#), [KoboToolbox](#), survey design, data validation, and digital data management.

6. Data Analysis Software

[Excel](#)/ [SPSS](#)/ [R](#) for quantitative analysis and [Tagutte](#)/ [NVivo](#)/ [ATLAS.ti](#)/ [MAXQDA](#) for qualitative analysis.

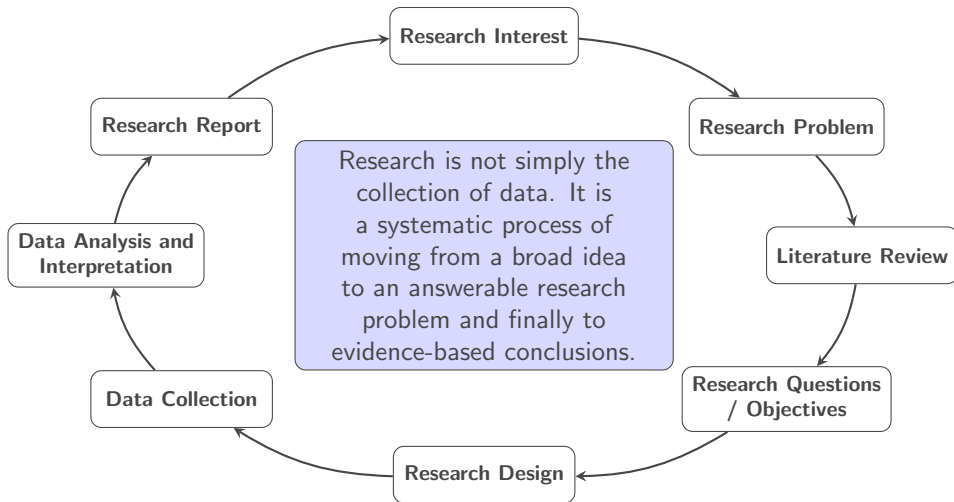
7. AI-Assisted Research

[Elicit](#) [Review Matrix, Metadata], [Consensus](#) [Review writing], [NotebookLM](#), [SciSpace](#),. Literature discovery, evidence synthesis, research paper analysis, citation verification, document-based research.

8. Research Project Management

[Notion](#) [Trello](#) [Task Management]; [Google Drive](#) [Cloud Storage, File Organization, Collaboration].

The Complete Research Journey



From Research Idea to Research Proposal

From Knowing Research Tools to Doing Research

Research Productivity Tools



Finding a Research Interest



Identifying a Real-World Problem



Developing a Research Topic



Finding Research Evidence

Activity I: Identify Your Research Interest

Ask yourself:

1. What subject or issue interests you the most?
2. Which area of Public Administration would you like to study?
3. Do you prefer studying **people, organizations, policies, institutions, or data**?
4. What problems have you observed in government or public service delivery?
5. Is there any issue that you would like to understand, explain, or improve?

Your Task

Write down **one broad area of research interest**.

Possible Research Interest Areas in Public Administration

- ▶ Public Policy
- ▶ Local Governance
- ▶ Public Service Delivery
- ▶ E-Governance
- ▶ Public Financial Management
- ▶ Public Sector Human Resource Management
- ▶ Development Administration
- ▶ Good Governance
- ▶ Citizen Participation
- ▶ Administrative Reform
- ▶ Public Accountability
- ▶ Digital Government
- ▶ Disaster Governance
- ▶ Gender and Social Inclusion

Remember

Your research interest is only the **starting point**. It is not yet a research problem.

From Interest to Research Topic

Interest Area

What I am interested in studying

+

Real-World Problem

What is happening or what needs to be understood or improved?

⇓

Research Topic

What my research will investigate, explain, or understand

Example: From Interest to Research Topic

Interest Area

Digital Public Service Delivery



Observed Problem

Citizens face difficulties accessing and using online public services.



Possible Research Topic

Barriers to Accessing Digital Public Services among Citizens

Possible Research Question

What factors create barriers to accessing digital public services?

Activity II: Identify a Real-World Problem

Think about your experience, workplace, community, or public institution.

Ask yourself:

- ▶ What problem have I observed?
- ▶ Who is affected by this problem?
- ▶ Why might this problem exist?
- ▶ Why is this problem important?
- ▶ Can this problem be investigated through research?

Your Task

Write one **real-world problem** related to your interest area.

From Interest and Problem to Research Topic

Interest Area	Observed Problem	Possible Research Topic
Digital Government	Citizens face difficulties accessing online services	Barriers to Accessing Digital Public Services
Local Governance	Limited citizen participation in local decision-making	Factors Affecting Citizen Participation in Local Governance
Public Service Delivery	Long waiting times and inefficient services	Factors Affecting Efficiency in Public Service Delivery
Public Accountability	Limited transparency in public institutions	Public Accountability and Transparency in Local Government

From Research Topic to Keywords

Example Research Topic

Barriers to Accessing Digital Public Services among Citizens

1. **Core Concepts**

Digital public services; access barriers

2. **Context**

Citizens; local government; Nepal

3. **Synonyms**

E-government; digital government; online public services

Possible Keywords

Digital government; e-government; online public services; access barriers; digital inclusion; citizens

Searching for Research Literature

Example Search String

"digital public services" AND "access barriers"

Alternative Search

("e-government" OR "digital government")
AND
("digital inclusion" OR "service access")
AND Nepal

- ▶ **AND** — includes both concepts
- ▶ **OR** — includes alternative terms
- ▶ **" "** — searches an exact phrase
- ▶ ***** — searches word variations

Practical Activity: Literature Search

Search your research topic using Google Scholar.

For each article, check:

1. Title
2. Author and year
3. Abstract
4. Research context
5. Methodology
6. Key findings
7. Citation count
8. Relevance to your research topic

Important

Do not simply collect papers. Read the abstract and evaluate whether the article is relevant to your research.

Organizing the Literature: Review Matrix

Author & Year	Study Focus	Method	Key Findings	Research Gap
Study 1				
Study 2				
Study 3				
Study 4				

Purpose

The review matrix helps you organize research evidence, compare studies, and identify possible research gaps.

From Literature Review to Research Gap

What do previous studies already tell us?
What is missing, limited, unclear, or unexplored?

Research Gap

The specific area where additional research is needed.

Examples:

- ▶ Limited evidence in a particular context
- ▶ Limited geographical or population coverage
- ▶ Methodological limitations
- ▶ Inconsistent research findings
- ▶ Important variables have been ignored

From Research Gap to Research Question

Research Problem

Citizens experience difficulties accessing digital public services.



Research Gap

Limited evidence exists regarding the specific barriers experienced by citizens in the selected context.



Research Question

What factors create barriers to citizens' access to digital public services?



Research Objective

To identify and examine the factors creating barriers to citizens' access to digital public services.

The Complete Research Journey



Your Semester II Research Journey

1. Research Interest
2. Research Problem
3. Research Topic
4. Literature Review and Research Gap
5. Research Questions and Objectives
6. Research Design and Methodology
7. Sampling and Data Collection
8. Data Analysis and Interpretation
9. Research Proposal
10. Research Report

Our Goal

By the end of this semester, you should be able to transform a research idea into a systematic research proposal and report.

Assignment for the Next Class

1. Identify **one research interest area**.
2. Identify **one real-world problem** related to that area.
3. Develop a preliminary **research topic**.
4. Extract at least **five keywords**.
5. Search for at least **five relevant research articles**.
6. Prepare a simple **literature review matrix**.
7. Identify one possible **research gap**.

Bring Your Work to the Next Class

Your preliminary work will be used to develop your **research problem, research questions, and objectives**.

Key Takeaway

Good research begins with a clear problem and ends with evidence-based conclusions.

Interest → Problem → Question → Evidence → Knowledge

Remember

A well-defined research problem is the foundation of a successful research study.

Thank You

Questions and Discussion

From curiosity to evidence, research is a journey of systematic inquiry.